

The First Clean Read

Maryland Market Intelligence | Week of August 31 - September 6, 2026

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A hyperlocal, data-driven weekly Maryland market report. This week's edition is a PDF in place of the usual interactive deck.

The Story of the Week

Renee and Theo Alvarez started looking in April.

By mid-July they had been outbid three times, once by \$40,000 over asking on a house they had walked through for eleven minutes. They decided to sit the rest of the summer out and come back when things calmed down.

They came back the week after Labor Day, and there was a little more room than there had been in the spring. There were 2,016 new listings across Maryland that week, and homes were taking a median of 21 days to go under contract, up from 18 the week before. And 2,098 listings had cut their asking price.

The house they liked was in Frederick County, where the median sale landed at about \$484,000 this week. It had been on the market a little over three weeks and the sellers had already trimmed the price once. Theo wanted to come in low. But their lender's quote had just moved from 6.66% to 6.71%, and on a 30-year note every eighth of a point is real money. So instead of a lowball they offered near the reduced list price, asked the sellers to cover part of the closing costs, and locked their rate that same afternoon.

It was accepted in two days. Not because they won a bidding war, but because on that house, this week, there wasn't one to win.

Here is what I would tell Renee and Theo, and anyone else reading this week's numbers. This is the first week in a month where the report can give an honest week-over-week read, because it is the first time two consecutive weeks of data have covered the full state (more on that below). And what that clean comparison shows is a market that is basically holding still: the same volume of homes selling, the same volume coming on, with a small give-back on price and a few days added to the typical time-to-contract as fall settles in. Not a boom. Not a stall. Steady, softening slightly at the edges. For a buyer with a rate lock in hand, that is a workable week. For a seller, it means the list price has to be right, because the market is no longer in a hurry to forgive an ambitious one.

Maryland in 60 Seconds

HOMES SOLD 1,150 +1.1%	NEW LISTINGS 2,016 flat -0.1%	PENDING 518 +5.7%	MEDIAN SOLD PRICE \$440,000 -2.2%
MEDIAN DAYS TO CONTRACT 21 days +3 from 18	PRICE REDUCTIONS 2,098 +0.4%	30-YR FIXED RATE 6.71% +5 bp	FMMI SCORE 50 / 100 -8 from 58*

* The FMMI move looks large but is not a real 8-point market decline. Last week's 58 was propped up by an apparent activity surge that turned out to be a data-coverage artifact (below). On clean data the underlying market barely moved; this week's 50 is the honest number, not a crash.

Read this first — the data-coverage note. For the weeks of August 10–16 and August 17–23, this report's Bright MLS pull was missing several county feeds, so the statewide totals for those weeks were undercounted. The first two pulls with the full 24-jurisdiction set are August 24–30 and this week. That means last week's headline — that closings and new listings had "nearly doubled" — was the data catching up, not the market moving. This week's comparison, August 24–30 to August 31–September 6, is the first genuinely like-for-like week-over-week read since early August. (One caveat: Howard County was not in this week's pull; its heat-map line is marked pending, roughly 63 closings backed out of the statewide totals.)

What the Numbers Really Mean

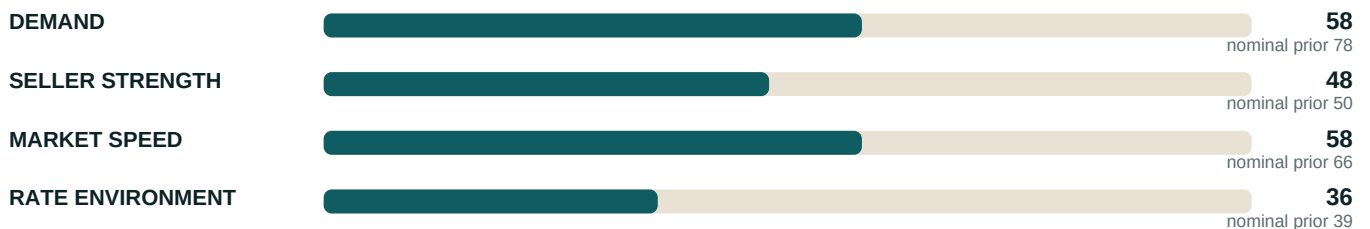
With all the data in, the market is close to flat. Closings edged up 1.1% to 1,150. New listings were dead flat at 2,016. Pending contracts rose 5.7% to 518, and price reductions barely moved at 2,098. Those are ordinary weekly wiggles, the kind you see in a market that is neither accelerating nor breaking down. The "surge" that framed last week's edition was an artifact of incomplete prior-week data, and it is gone from the picture now.

The real movement this week was a mild softening on price and pace. The median sold price slipped 2.2% to \$440,000, and the median new-listing price fell the same \$10,000, to \$419,900. The median time-to-contract slowed from 18 days to 21. And the mortgage rate rose for a second straight week. None of these is a large move on its own, but they all point the same way: a little more room for buyers, a little less urgency behind sellers, right on schedule for the turn into fall.

The softening is real but shallow. Even with 2,098 price reductions statewide and a \$10,000 dip in the median, the typical home that closed this week still sold for 99.0% of its *original* list price. Sellers are trimming, but they are not capitulating.

The Friedman Market Momentum Index (FMMI)

50 / 100 — Balanced Market, Holding Steady (nominally down from 58 last week)



Maryland's market is close to the middle of the scale and barely moved this week. The eight-point drop from last week is mostly the Aug 24–30 score correcting itself — that 58 was built partly on a Demand reading of 78 that came from an apparent activity surge, which turned out to be a data-coverage artifact. Strip that out and the market has been sitting near this level the whole time. A recalibration to the real picture, not a market that fell apart in seven days.

- **Demand 58** (nominal prior 78) — On clean data, closings were flat and pending rose 5.7%. Healthy volume near 1,150 closings a week, but no upward momentum behind it.
- **Seller Strength 48** (prior 50) — Median sold price fell 2.2% and the median new-listing price fell the same \$10,000; reductions held elevated at 2,098. Offsetting that: closed homes still realized a median 99.0% of original list.
- **Market Speed 58** (prior 66) — Median days-to-contract slowed from 18 to 21. Still fast historically, but easing.
- **Rate Environment 36** (prior 39) — The Freddie Mac 30-year fixed rose five basis points to 6.71%, its second straight weekly increase.

The Friedman Signal: Steady

For the first time in a month, this report can compare two weeks of complete, full-state data, and the comparison shows a market holding its level. The same number of homes are selling, the same number are coming on, and pending contracts are ticking up. What changed this week is small and consistent: the median sold price gave back \$10,000, homes took three days longer to reach contract, and the mortgage rate rose again. A market in a steady state with a mild autumn softening, not one accelerating or breaking. Watch two things next week: whether closings and new listings stay near this week's levels, and whether the median price stabilizes or keeps sliding.

Market Spotlight: Carroll County & Harford County

Carroll County

Carroll County closed 44 homes this week at a \$533,000 median, and here is the number that stands out: closed homes sold at an average of 101.0% of their *original* list price. Not their reduced price, their first one. In a week when the statewide median fell and price cuts stayed elevated, Carroll sellers were still beating their opening ask. The average days on market reads 30, but the median is 10 — the typical Carroll home is going under contract fast, with a few longer-sitting listings pulling the average up. Kyle's home county remains one of the tightest in the state.

Closed: 44 | Median Sold: \$533,000 | Avg. DOM: 30 (median 10) | Sold / Orig. List: 101.0%

Harford County

Harford County posted the fastest pace in Maryland this week: a 25-day average days on market across 55 closings, at a \$395,000 median. That is real speed on a real sample, not a small-county fluke. Homes there sold at a median 100.0% of list price. For buyers priced out of Baltimore County or looking for more house per dollar within commuting range, Harford is moving quickly and cleanly right now.

Closed: 55 | Median Sold: \$395,000 | Avg. DOM: 25 | Sold / List: 100.0%

Bottom line: Carroll is winning on price and Harford is winning on speed, and both are doing it in a week when the statewide numbers softened. Strength in this market is local, and right now it is concentrated north of Baltimore.

This Week's Price Extremes

No individual listing sheet was provided this week, so these are statewide aggregate values from the Bright MLS pull rather than specific named properties.

- **Priciest sale:** \$6,250,000 (originally listed \$6,950,000) — the highest closed price in the state this week.
- **Most affordable sale:** \$7,000 — the low end of the range, almost certainly land or a shell-condition rehab.
- **New listings this week** ranged from \$2,250 to \$7,445,000 in original list price.

Friedman Heat Map: Fastest & Slowest Counties

Hottest — Fastest Average DOM

County	Avg. DOM	Closings
Harford County	25 days	55
Anne Arundel County	28 days	124
Frederick County	29 days	74
Montgomery County	30 days	148

Baltimore County	30 days	136
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Carroll County also posted a 30-day average on 44 closings, with a median DOM of just 10 (see Market Spotlight).

Cooling — Slowest Average DOM

County	Avg. DOM	Closings
Talbot County	128 days	16
Garrett County	114 days	19
Kent County	76 days	10
Dorchester County	74 days	11
Worcester County	56 days	32

Talbot and Garrett, both higher-priced, second-home-heavy markets, sit well clear of the rest of the state on time-to-sell. Dorchester lands near the bottom again, though it got a little faster than the week before. Pace right now is strongest in the counties ringing Baltimore and weakest on the rural Eastern Shore and in far Western Maryland. *Howard County: data pending this week.*

Week Over Week

This is the first clean comparison in a month — both weeks have the full 24-county set (this week minus Howard). The Aug 17–23 to Aug 24–30 comparison behind last week's "surge" straddled the data-coverage gap and should be disregarded.

Metric	Last Wk (8/24-8/30)	This Wk (8/31-9/6)	Change
Closed Sales (Statewide)	1,137	1,150	+13 (+1.1%)
New Listings	2,019	2,016	-3 (-0.1%)
Pending Contracts	490	518	+28 (+5.7%)
Price Reductions	2,090	2,098	+8 (+0.4%)
Median Sold Price	\$450,000	\$440,000	-\$10,000 (-2.2%)
Median New-Listing Price	\$429,900	\$419,900	-\$10,000 (-2.3%)
Days to Contract (Closed CDOM)	18	21	+3 days
30-Year Mortgage Rate	6.66%	6.71%	+5 bp

The volume metrics were flat; every price and pace metric ticked the wrong way for sellers. A quiet week, with a consistent lean toward buyers.

Winners & Losers This Week

Winners

- **Buyers with a rate lock in hand** — 2,016 new listings, a slower pace, and 2,098 price reductions to negotiate against.
- **Harford County** — fastest market in Maryland, 25-day average across 55 closings, homes selling at full list.
- **Carroll County** — closed homes sold at an average 101.0% of original list price, \$533,000 median, still beating opening ask.

Losing Momentum

- **Seller Strength** — down to 48 from 50; median price off 2.2%, reductions still elevated at 2,098.
- **Rate-sensitive buyers** — 6.66% → 6.71%, the second straight weekly increase.

- **Talbot County** — 128-day average days on market as high-end Eastern Shore inventory sits.

One Thing I'd Do This Week

If I were buying: Get the rate lock first, then shop. The rate is trending up, but the extra inventory and the 2,098 price cuts mean you can push on price and terms in a way you could not in the spring. Spend your leverage on the contract, not on waiting for a better week.

If I were selling: Price to your first number, not your second. The homes that needed a cut this week are the ones still sitting. The ones priced right on day one are still going under contract in about three weeks at essentially full ask (99.0% of original list, median, statewide).

If I were investing: Look where days on market is stretching — Talbot (128), Garrett (114), Kent (76), Dorchester (74). Thinner buyer pools and longer holds, but that is also where the motivated sellers and the real negotiating room are right now.

Deep Dive: The Surprising Fact This Week

99.0% — the median ratio of sold price to *original* list price across every Maryland home that closed this week. Not the most recent list price, the very first one.

It matters because of everything happening around it. There were 2,098 price reductions statewide this week. The median sold price fell \$10,000. Homes are taking longer to go under contract. By every one of those measures, this looks like a market where sellers are losing ground. And yet the typical closed sale still landed within one percent of the number the seller asked on day one.

The reconciliation: the price weakness this week is concentrated in the listings that mispriced at launch and had to chase the market down. The homes that were priced correctly from the start are still selling at, or very near, full ask. In a softening market the gap between those two outcomes widens, and this week it was wide. (The average sold-to-original ratio was 97.6%, pulled below the median by a smaller number of deeply discounted sales.)

Bonus From My Kitchen: Maryland Crab & Corn Chowder

The first cool nights of September, the last of the local sweet corn, and crab still running in the Bay. There is exactly one week a year this dish is perfectly in season, and this is it. **Serves 4-6.**

Ingredients: 4 strips bacon, chopped; 1 medium onion, diced; 2 celery stalks, diced; 3 tbsp flour; 4 cups seafood or chicken stock; 2 medium Yukon Gold potatoes, peeled and diced; 3 ears fresh corn, kernels cut off (about 2 cups); 1 cup heavy cream; 1 lb Maryland lump crab meat, picked over; 1 tsp Old Bay, plus more to taste; salt and pepper; chopped chives or parsley.

1. Cook the bacon in a heavy pot over medium heat until crisp. Remove and set aside, leaving the fat in the pot.
2. Cook the onion and celery in the fat until soft, about 5 minutes. Stir in the flour and cook 1 minute more.
3. Whisk in the stock a little at a time so it stays smooth. Add the potatoes, simmer until tender, about 12 minutes.
4. Add the corn and cream and simmer 5 minutes.
5. Gently fold in the crab and Old Bay and warm through, about 2 minutes. Do not let it boil hard or the crab toughens.
6. Season with salt, pepper, and more Old Bay to taste. Serve topped with the crispy bacon and chives.

Crusty bread and a green salad make it dinner. It reheats well; add the crab fresh to each reheated bowl if you can.

Let's Talk

Whether you're thinking about selling or searching for your next home, the right information makes all the difference. Ask for a real, data-backed valuation of your home, or set up live MLS alerts for exactly what you're looking for.

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Why Choose Kyle: 80% more views than comparable listings • 5,000+ calls a month to find your buyer • cinematic video and best-in-class photography • Zillow Showcase premium placement • an investor's mindset on every deal since 2018.

Equal Housing Opportunity. Kyle Friedman is a licensed Maryland real estate agent. Data source: Bright MLS, week of August 31 - September 6, 2026 (23 of 24 counties; Howard County pending; prior two weeks' pulls were missing counties and are not comparable). Mortgage rate: Freddie Mac PMMS, released September 3, 2026.